A-A-50212A
18 May 1988
SUPERSEDING
A-A-50212
July 28, 1983

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

PARALLEL RULER

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Federal Specification GG-P-118.

This description covers stepping or folding parallel rulers used in general drafting and navigation to draw and lay out parallel lines.

Salient characteristics:

Design. The parallel rulers shall consist of two parallel blades linked together by two or three bars. The blades shall have knobs to facilitate spreading and friction pads on the undersides (see figure 1).

Material.

Metal - Chrome plated brass, anodized aluminum, or corrosion-resisting steel. (Only one of the listed metals shall be selected. Combination of metals is not allowed. The selected metal shall be compatible with the selected hardwood and plastic).
Hardwood - Straight-grained, seasoned; moisture content 6-14 percent.
Plastic - Molded styrene-butadiene.

Class.

1 - Wood - The blade shall be one continuous piece of hardwood.
2 - Plastic - The blade shall be one continuous piece of plastic.

Part number. The document part number for the parallel ruler shall be as follows:

A50212 - X - Y

- Y: Size 06, 12, 15, 18 or 24
- X: Class 1 or 2
- A50212: CID identification number

AMSC N/A FSC 6675

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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Size. The rulers shall be furnished in the following sizes:

Size	Length (inches) ±1/16	Width (inches) ±1/16	Thickness (inch) ±3/64
06	6	1-1/4	3/16
12	12	1-1/4	3/16
15	15	1-1/4	3/16
18	18	1-1/4	3/16
24	24	1-1/2	3/16

Bars. Metal or plastic. Ruler sized 6 through 18 shall have two bars. Rulers size 24 shall have three bars.

Friction pads. One pad attached to the underside of each blade near each end. On ruler sizes 12 through 24, an additional pad attached near the center of each blade.

Accuracy. When the instrument is in working position, the blades shall remain true to their common plane, and the ruling edge of both blades shall be parallel within 0.01 inch per foot of length at all positions.

Regulatory requirements. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practicable.

Packaging and marking. Military packaging shall be specified when shipments are shipped to overseas Department of Defense (DoD) consignees. Commercial packaging may be specified for shipments to DoD consignees within the continental United States and to non-DoD consignees worldwide. When a supplier's normal packaging will satisfy the requirements for military packaging, it may be used.

Military packaging. Each parallel ruler shall be preserved and packed to protect against physical damage and deterioration in a logistic environment characterized by the following:

1. Multiple handling during transportation and in-transit storage.
2. Shock, vibration, and static loading forces during worldwide shipment by all transport modes.
3. Uncontrolled warehouse storage for extended periods.
4. Weather exposure during shipment and in-transit transfers.
5. Stacking loads during shipment and storage.

Quantities of parallel rulers of one class and size destined to a single addressee may be unitized into one or more unit loads.

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Commercial. Each parallel ruler shall be packaged in accordance with the supplier's normal method for retail distribution. Individually packaged, parallel rulers of one class and size shipped to a single destination may be unitized to permit handling as a single unit. Shipping containers shall comply with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification rules.

Marking. Unit, intermediate (when provided), and exterior packs shall be marked with the item nomenclature, stock or part number, quantity per pack, and contract number as a minimum; additional marking shall be as specified in the contract or order. Exterior packs shall have in addition the complete consignee's address. Markings shall be applied in a legible manner, in a contrasting color, of an appropriate size, and of waterproof materials.

Quality assurance. Each parallel ruler shall be examined for the following defects. Presence of one or more defects shall be cause for rejection.

1. Design not as specified.
2. Material not as specified.
3. Class not as specified.
4. Size(s) not as specified.
5. Bars not as specified.
6. Friction pads not as specified.
7. Accuracy not as specified.
8. Packaging and marking not as specified.

Certification of commercial item. The contractor shall furnish certification for Government approval that the product offered to the Government meets the salient characteristics of this description and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices and is the same product as the manufacturer's current product offered by the contractor in the commercial market place for at least one year preceding the solicitation. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Small business. A small business that cannot meet the certification-of-commercial-item requirement of this document, may make an offer under this solicitation; and, if such small business is the apparent successful offeror, the Government may require the small business to submit a sample folding type parallel ruler. Any such parallel ruler may be evaluated for this solicitation if time to contract award permits. Such evaluation would be to determine conformance to all requirements of this commercial item description and to determine equivalency to parallel rulers available in the commercial marketplace in the areas of durability, human factors engineering, and safety. It should be

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noted that bid samples are not required unless specifically requested by the contracting officer. Note. The Government may elect not to evaluate a bid sample from an apparent low bidder for award for this solicitation if a determination of urgency is made by the contracting officer. The bid sample would then be evaluated prior to future solicitation for comparable items.

Notes:

1. Ordering activity shall specify class and size.
2. When this commercial item description is used for procurement, the commercial item certification clause must appear in the solicitation.
3. Figure: The figure shows the basic design for a parallel ruler which has been found acceptable; however, the figure is for illustration only and is not intended to preclude the furnishing of other designs which conform to the salient characteristics.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians

Army - ME
Air Force - 99

Review activity

DLA - GS
Air Force - 82

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATION ACTIVITIES:

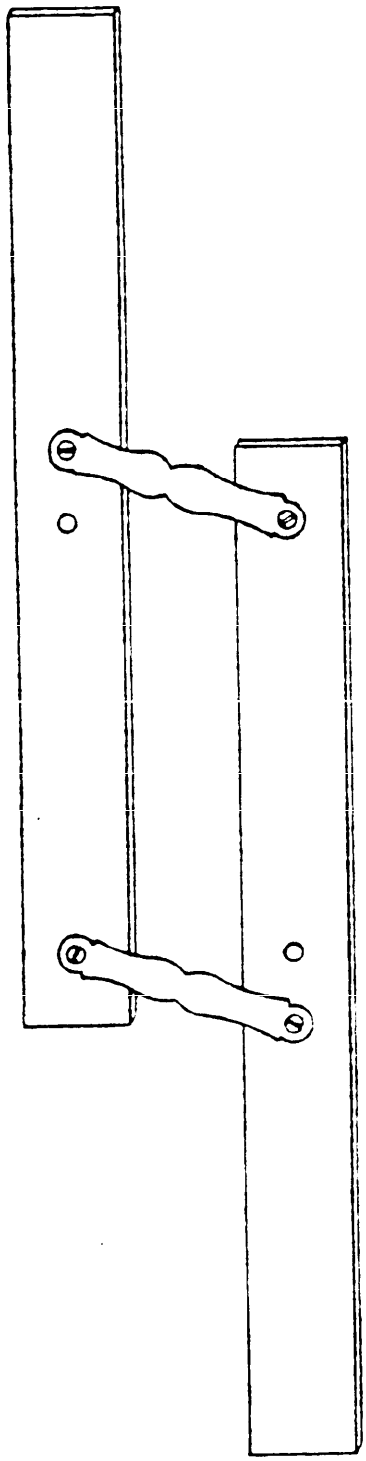
GSA - FCGC
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

Army - ME

Project 6675-0813

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FIGURE 1. Parallel ruler.

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